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School Health

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- Schools are essential for young people to acquire knowledge, socioemotional skills including selfregulation and resilience, and critical thinking skills that provide the foundation for a healthy future.
- Access to education and safe and supportive school environments have been linked to better health outcomes.
- Good health is linked to reduced drop-out rates and greater educational attainment, educational performance, employment and productivity.



- WHO has long recognized the link between health and education and the potential for schools to play a central role in safeguarding student health and well-being.
- In 1995, WHO launched the Global School Health Initiative, which aimed to strengthen approaches to health promotion in schools.
- Among those approaches, pairing children with health services occupies an important place.



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SCHOOL HEALTH





Health & Wellness Department

- Public Schools values the importance of access for all to a well rounded academic experience that includes health services and health and wellness related learning opportunities that enhance our students' overall health & well-being.
- Schools takes a coordinated school health approach through the provision of a variety of health resources, supports and learning opportunities.





- Through the offering of district wide comprehensive and evidenced based health & physical education programming at the elementary, middle school and high school levels.
- To providing access for all students and families to licensed social workers, adjustment counselors, school nurses, community resources, after school enrichment opportunities, and learning opportunities related to supporting adolescent health and well-being.



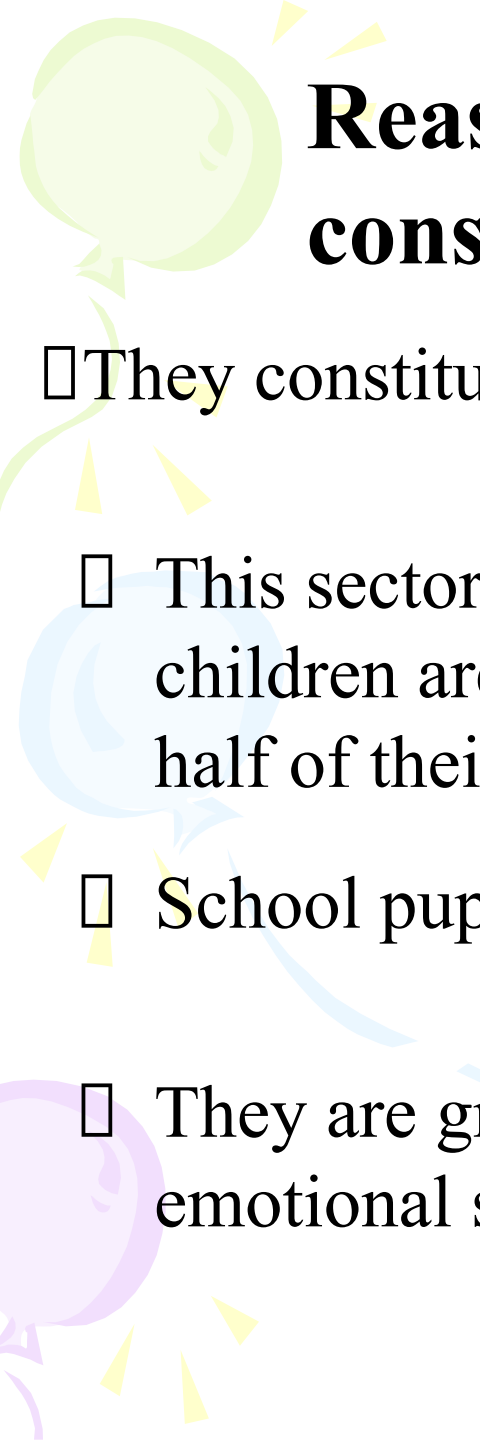
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Why school health is important

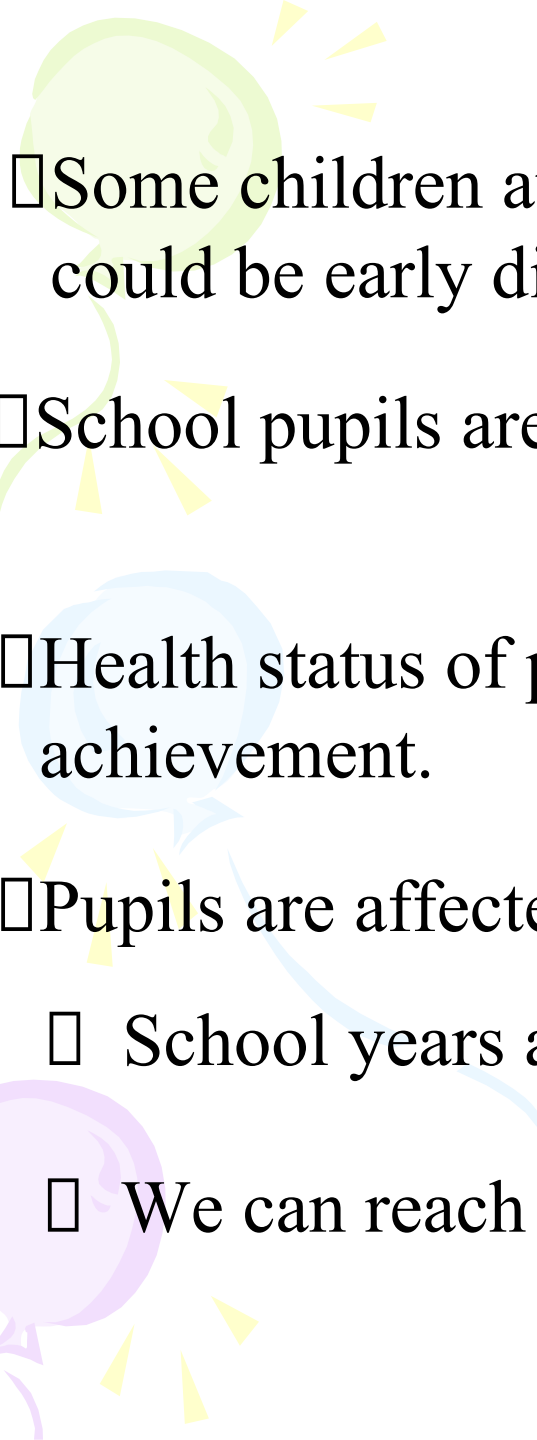
- Schools are a strategic means of providing children with educational qualifications that will enable them to find employment and status in life.
- Schools can be dynamic settings for promoting health, for enabling children to grow and mature into healthy adults, yet the potential of the school to enhance health is often underutilized.
- ' School Health' has largely remained confined to medical check-ups of children and/or some hours of health instruction in the curriculum.

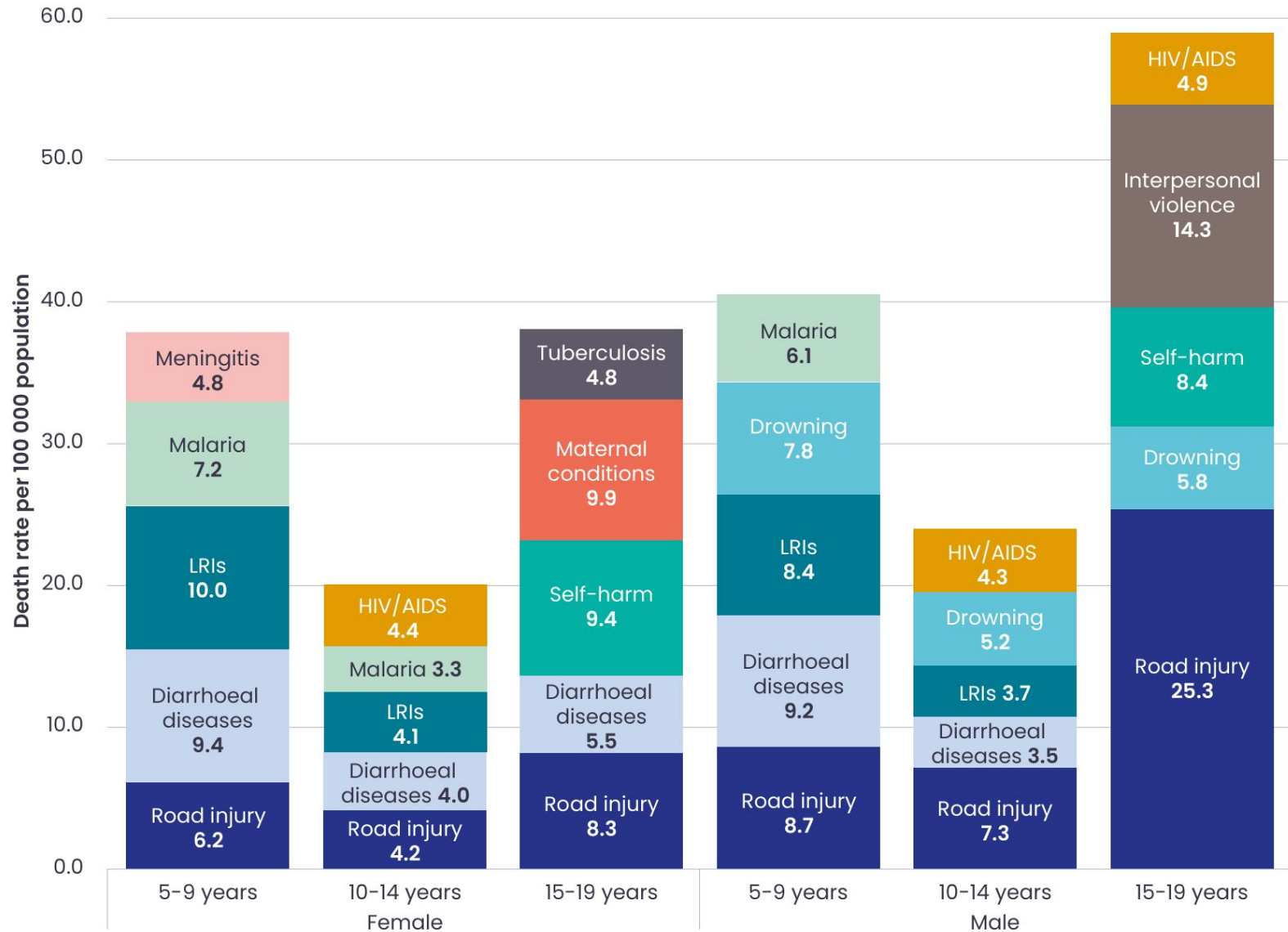


Reasons for giving school age special consideration:

- They constitute a big sector of the population (about 1/6).
- This sector is easily reached through schools, as by law, children are compelled to attend schools and spend about half of their day for a period of 9 years.
- School pupils are considered a vulnerable group.
- They are growing exposed physiologic, mental and emotional stress at home or school.



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- Some children attend school with different health problems, could be early discovered and treated.
 - School pupils are very active & curious so liable to accidents.
 - Health status of pupils is a strong determinant of their school achievement.
 - Pupils are affected by school environment.
 - School years are the best opportunity for health education.
 - We can reach parents through their children.



Global estimates of top-five causes of death for school-age children and adolescents, by sex and age group, 2016 Source: WHO (14).



Objectives of School Health

1. Promote Physical Health

- Ensure normal growth and development of students.
- Prevent communicable and non-communicable diseases.
- Promote personal hygiene and healthy habits.

2. Prevent Disease and Detect Health Problems Early

- Conduct regular health screening and medical examinations.
- Identify vision, hearing, dental, nutritional, and mental health problems early.
- Provide timely referral and follow-up care.





3. Promote Mental, Emotional, and Social Well-Being

- Support positive mental health and emotional stability.
- Reduce stress, anxiety, bullying, and behavioral problems.
- Encourage healthy social relationships and self-esteem.

4. Ensure a Safe and Healthy School Environment

- Maintain clean, safe, and hygienic school facilities.
- Prevent accidents and injuries within school premises.
- Ensure safe drinking water, sanitation, and waste management.



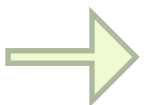


5. Promote Nutrition and Healthy Eating

- Improve nutritional status of children.
- Encourage balanced diets and healthy food choices.
- Prevent malnutrition, obesity, and micronutrient deficiencies.

6. Develop Health Knowledge and Life Skills

- Educate students about health, hygiene, and disease prevention.
- Promote life skills such as decision-making, problem-solving, and self-care.
- Encourage responsible health behaviors.





7. Prevent Risky Behaviors

- Discourage tobacco, alcohol, drug use, and other harmful practices.
- Promote healthy lifestyle choices and physical activity.
- Support sexual and reproductive health education (age-appropriate).

8. Provide First Aid and Emergency Care

- Ensure availability of first aid services at school.
- Train staff and students in basic first aid and emergency response.
- Manage minor illnesses and injuries promptly.



9. Strengthen School–Family–Community Linkage

- Involve parents in school health activities.
- Coordinate with health services and community organizations.
- Promote shared responsibility for child health.

10. Support Academic Performance

- Improve attendance and concentration through better health.
- Reduce absenteeism due to illness.
- Enhance overall learning capacity and school performance.



Targets of School Health

School health programs are designed to benefit **multiple target groups**, not only students.

The main targets are:

1. Students

- Promote physical, mental, emotional, and social well-being
- Prevent diseases and detect health problems early
- Develop healthy habits and life skills

2. Teachers and School Staff

- Maintain good physical and mental health
- Reduce occupational health risks and stress
- Improve awareness of first aid, safety, and disease prevention



3.School Environment

- Ensure safe, clean, and healthy school facilities
- Promote sanitation, safe water, and proper waste management
- Prevent accidents and environmental health hazards

4.Parents and Families

- Increase awareness of child health and nutrition
- Encourage healthy behaviors at home
- Strengthen cooperation between school and family



5. Community

- Promote community participation in child health programs
- Control communicable diseases through collaboration
- Support public health initiatives and awareness

6. School System / Education Sector

- Improve student attendance and academic performance
- Reduce absenteeism due to illness
- Create a health-supportive learning environment

8

Component Model of School Health Programme

**Physical
Education**

**Nutrition
Services**

**(Staff) Health
Promotion**

**Health
Education**

**Health
Services**

**Safe
Environment**

**Couselling
Services**

**Community
Engagement**



1. School Health Education and Instruction

- This aims to encourage healthy and hygienic behavior among students through learning experiences that build desirable health practices.
- It usually consists of joint efforts between teachers and other health personnel.
- School health education and instruction provides students with health skills like personal hygiene, first aid, body education and environmental sanitation for life.



2. School Health Services

- School health services help to protect and prevent diseases, and provide curative services for the promotion of good health status among the students and staffs.
- School health services make it possible for students to achieve maximum health for academic excellence.



□ Some of the services rendered by school health services include:

- Routine health examinations and assessment.
- Control and prevention of communicable diseases through early detection, isolation, treatment, vaccination and education.
- Care and treatment of minor medical and dental ailments, provision of proper emergency care and referral.
- Counselling and education on proper ways to handle health defects and problems.



3. Healthy and Safe Environment /Infrastructure

Healthy and safe school environment is concerned with the physical setting and existing condition of the school in regards to health.

This involves:

- Standard building with safety precautions
- Effective refuse and sewage disposal systems
- Well-equipped playgrounds
- Safe water supply
- Recess
- Number of students per class
- Length of period for each class
- Discipline
- Provision of school mid-day meals





- A safe school environment also fosters healthy relationships among the students, teachers and members of staff of the school.
- It creates a healthy learning environment for students and promotes a safe place for social interactions between students, students and teachers and among teachers.



4. Nutrition and School Feeding Services

This involves ensuring adequate nourishment for each student, examining the health and nutrition needs of all students.

Nutrition and school feeding services include:

- Inspection of food sold by vendors within the school environment, to ensure that it is prepared in a safe manner and can be consumed by the students.
- Provision of subsidized mid-day meals to meet at least one third of the daily requirements of all major and micro-nutrients as well as maintain lifelong, healthy eating patterns.
- Select, organise and present a food time table for students.



5. Physical Education

- Physical education is the study of the movement of the human body.
- It involves engaging the students in simple games that help to develop motor skills and cognitive abilities.
- As part of school health programme, students engage in physical activities like rhythmic and dance activities, team games [e.g. football, basketball], individual games, and physical fitness exercises.
- Studies have shown that physical activities promote academic performance in students.

6. Parent and Community Involvement

- Parents and individuals within the community actively participate in school health programme by providing the school with financial resources, and services to respond effectively to the health needs of the students.
- These could also include health personnel among parents and the community volunteering to give health talks and seminars on current health trends and basic hygiene, provision of first aid material and resources that teachers can use to facilitate health education and instruction.



7. Mental Health Services

- These are services that are provided to improve both staff and student's mental, emotional, and social health.
- Counselling and emotional support are offered by professionals like psychologist, counselors and social workers.



8. Health Promotion in Staff

- This is a conscious effort on the part of the school to ensure that their staffs are in good health.
- This is done by engaging the staff in activities such as immunization, health workshops/programmes, well-timed breaks, and health related fitness exercises to promote desirable health behaviors and practices among them.



9.Employee Wellness

Opportunities for school staff to improve their own health status through activities like health assessments, health education, and fitness activities. [

10.Social & Emotional Climate

The psychosocial environment of the school, including the quality of relationships among students, staff, and families.



11. Screening Program in School Health

A **school health screening program** is a systematic process to identify health problems early among students to allow timely intervention, referral, and follow-up.

1. General Physical Examination
2. Vision Screening
3. Hearing Screening
4. Dental Screening
5. Nutritional Screening
6. Screening for Communicable Diseases
7. Mental and Behavioral Health Screening
8. Postural and Musculoskeletal Screening
9. Special Screening (Age-Appropriate)
 - Speech and language problems
 - Pubertal and adolescent health issues



12. Medical care and referral

School health units,

- Referrals to specialized clinics,
- Referrals to hospitals for diagnosis and treatment of disease.
- Some cases may need specialized diagnosis or/and management.



Components of the policy

The eight components of the comprehensive school Health Policy are:

1. A School environment that is safe
2. A sequential Health Education curriculum taught daily in every grade
3. A sequential Physical Education curriculum taught daily in every grade
4. A nutrition services program that includes a food service program and employs well- prepared staff who efficiently serve appealing choices of nutritious foods



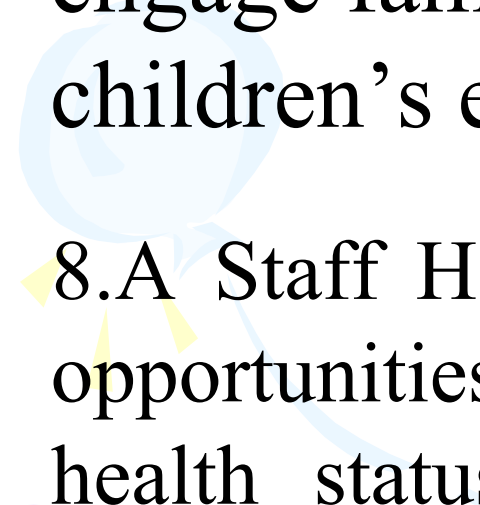
5. A school Health Services Program that is designed to ensure access or referral to primary health care services, prevent and control communicable disease and other health problems

6. A counseling ,Psychological, and Social Services Program that is designed to ensure access or referral to assessments, interventions, and other services for student's mental, emotional, and social health and whose services are provided for by well-qualified and well-supported professionals.





7. Integrated Family and Community
Involvement activities that are designed to
engage families as active participants in their
children's education



8. A Staff Health Promotion Policy that provides
opportunities for school staff to improve their
health status through activities such as health
assessments, health, education and health-related
fitness activities.





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Policy, planning,
financing

Department
of Health

Department
of Education

Private sector

NGOs

Other key
departments,
such as social
services,
water and
sanitation,
finance

Implementation

School health services

School staff
(principal,
administration,
teachers)

Families
(parents/
guardians,
other family
members)

School-based health
services

School-linked
health services^a

With
on-site
health
personnel
only

With both
on-site
and visiting
health
personnel

With visiting
health
personnel
only

**Other health
and social
services**
(primary health
care, specialist
health services,
social services)

Beneficiaries

Students/learners

Improved coverage and quality of health services, and improvement in students' health and education outcomes, with equity



Thank you